

Colorado Field Ornithologists Sight Record Form

2000 - 17

CFO-RC FILE X:

RESULTS:

Species:(Common Name) Glossy Ibis

(Scientific Name) *Plegadis falcinellus*

Date(s) of occurrence: 21 April 2000

Number of birds seen: 1

Sex: male ?? (large)

Plumage: alternate (adult)

Location: Lake Cheraw (west side)

Photos: video taken through scope--captured stills included below.

Length of observation: 20 minutes

Time(s) of observation: 9:00 – 9:20 am (roughly)

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: Brandon Percival

Other Observers who independently saw the bird(s): ??

Conditions: Mostly sunny. Good light. Nice. ☺

Optical equipment used: B & L Elite 10 x 42 binocular.

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 75 meters

Habitat: wetland

Details:

While scanning through a flock of ca. 50 *Plegadis* Ibis, I found a different looking ibis. Brandon looked at it and concurred that it was a Glossy Ibis. Overall the bird was similar to the numerous White-faced Ibis, being just slightly larger and mostly purple-chestnut in color with iridescent bronzy-green wings and a long drooped bill. The bronzy coloration of the wings and rich chestnut color indicated the bird was an adult in alternate plumage. The bird differed from the alternate plumaged White-faced Ibis in the following respects (see figures 1 – 3):

1. The facial skin was dark bluish-gray (not pink).
2. The facial skin was not completely surrounded by white. Rather, a narrow bluish-white line went from just above and in front of the eye to just above the bill. A similar, but less noticeable, line went from below and in front of the eye to the base of the bill.
3. Dark eye (lacking red iris).
4. The legs were duller, with somewhat contrasting reddish knees. (See Figure 3.) This feature was not as noticeable as I have seen in other Glossy Ibis, but I suspect this feature is variable. Nevertheless, the full alternate White-faced Ibis had brighter red legs.
5. The bill lacked the pinkish tones of the White-faced Ibis, and was olive in color.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? I have seen thousands of both species, and studied many of each.

List books, guides, recordings or other sources consulted and how this influenced your identification (during and after observation): None.

This report is from notes made during observation.

Date of written report: 5 February 2001

Reporting observer: Christopher L. Wood, zeledonia@att.net

Signature: *Christopher L. Wood (electronic submission)*

Reporting Observer's Address: 3465 S Otis Court

City: Lakewood

State: Colorado

Zip: 80227

Photos captured from video taken through scope. Note some distortion because of shooting video through scope.



Figure 1

#2000-17



Photos captured from video taken through scope. Note some distortion because of shooting video through scope.



Figure 1

(poor color -
see reverse or
CD)





Figure 3